

# Foundations of Āyurveda

## IK 702

Prof. Ashish Karn

### *Lecture Plan and Pre-reading Schedule*

| Lec. | Pre-reading Essay                                                            | Lecture Topic                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Does medicine have a philosophy?                                             | The Need for <i>Āyurveda</i> and Holistic Health in Contemporary Society; History of Medicine in Greece and Europe, Indian influence on them, and the role of <i>Āyurveda</i> in Integrative Medicine. |
| 2    | What Is Missing in Our Modern Understanding of Health?                       | <i>Āyurveda</i> and its place in the Indian corpus of texts. Definition, purpose, eight branches, origins, major schools, <i>Bṛhat-trayī</i> and <i>Laghutrayī</i> .                                   |
| 3    | Symptomatic Relief or Health Restoration? Disease Management or Cure?        | <i>Āyurveda</i> vis-à-vis Western medicine. Some astounding leaps of <i>Āyurvedic</i> insight in the history of science.                                                                               |
| 4    | The primordial cause of disease                                              | Fundamental principles behind disease and health: <i>Prajñāparādha</i> and <i>Asātmendriyārtha Saṃyoga</i> .                                                                                           |
| 5    | How everyday living creates disease                                          | <i>Āyurveda</i> as more than a medical system. The six systems of Vedic philosophy and their relationship with <i>Āyurveda</i> .                                                                       |
| 6    | Time, speed, and acceleration - How disease is created                       | <i>Pañcamahābhūtas</i> and <i>Triguṇas</i> . Evolution and dissolution of matter. Twenty <i>Dravyaguṇas</i> .                                                                                          |
| 7    | What does the creation of the universe have to do with the human body?       | <i>Tridoṣa Siddhānta</i> . Relationship of <i>Doṣas</i> with <i>Pañcamahābhūtas</i> . <i>Guṇas</i> of the <i>Doṣas</i> . <i>Sāmānya-Viśeṣa Siddhānta</i> .                                             |
| 8    | Know your own <i>Āyurvedic Prakṛti</i>                                       | <i>Prakṛti</i> and <i>Vikṛti</i> . Physical and psychological characteristics of different constitutions.                                                                                              |
| 9    | Is fast always better in medicine? Is treating symptoms the same as healing? | Introduction to <i>Doṣa</i> , <i>Dhātu</i> and <i>Mala</i> . Five subdivisions of <i>Vāta</i> , <i>Pitta</i> and <i>Kapha</i> .                                                                        |
| 10   | The physician - scientist, technician or healer?                             | <i>Dhātus</i> , <i>Upadhātus</i> and <i>Dhātumalas</i> .                                                                                                                                               |

| Lec. | Pre-reading Essay                                                                  | Lecture Topic                                                                                                                                                  |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11   | The science of deep breathing                                                      | <i>Ṣaḍaṅga Śarīra, Prāṇāyātana, Trimarma and Srotas.</i>                                                                                                       |
| 12   | Reactive Oxygen Species, Aging, and the Forgotten Science of Balance               | <i>Sapta Dhātu Srotas:</i> origin, vitiation and symptoms.                                                                                                     |
| 13   | <i>Sparsā, Āyurveda,</i> and the Forgotten Language of Nourishing Contact          | <i>Pācana Kriyā: Sthūla and Sūkṣma</i> digestion. <i>Ojas.</i>                                                                                                 |
| 14   | Spiritual aspects of healing                                                       | <i>Manas</i> in <i>Āyurveda</i> . The tripod of life, emotions and psychosomatic disorders.                                                                    |
| 15   | What is good health?                                                               | Definition of <i>Svāsthya</i> from <i>Suśruta Saṃhitā</i> . Three <i>Upastambhas</i> with emphasis on <i>Nidrā</i> and <i>Brahmacarya</i> . Circadian rhythms. |
| 16   | <i>Āyurvedic</i> insights on sleep: The silent regulator of life                   | <i>Āhāra Vidhi Vidhāna</i> . Eight factors affecting the influence of diet.                                                                                    |
| 17   | आहारशुद्धौ सत्त्वशुद्धिः                                                           | <i>Viruddha Āhāra</i> , proper food combinations, <i>Avasthāpāka</i> , proper timing and sequence of meals.                                                    |
| 18   | Can a balanced diet throw you out of balance?                                      | <i>Rasa, Vīrya, Vipāka, Ṣaḍrasa Siddhānta</i> and Twenty <i>Dravyaguṇas</i> of foods.                                                                          |
| 19   | <i>Āyurveda</i> and aging: <i>Rasāyana</i> or rejuvenation therapy                 | <i>Āyurvedic Herbology</i> . Herbs for different <i>Doṣas</i> , herbs for the mind, formulations and processing techniques.                                    |
| 20   | <i>Āyurveda</i> and the healing power of vision                                    | Healing through herbs, aromas, sound, touch and vision.                                                                                                        |
| 21   | Healing begins by slowing down the mind                                            | Healing through herbs, aromas, sound, touch and vision.                                                                                                        |
| 22   | An <i>Āyurvedic</i> perspective on sound, memory and neuroplasticity               | <i>Dinacaryā</i> . Healing rhythms of life with contemporary scientific evidence.                                                                              |
| 23   | Exercise and breathing: Western approach vis-à-vis an <i>Āyurvedic</i> perspective | <i>Dinacaryā, Sadvṛtta</i> and idiopathic causes of disease.                                                                                                   |
| 24   | Nasya Karma: Where <i>Āyurveda</i> meets modern neuroscience                       | <i>Rtucaryā</i> . Seasonal regimen. <i>Dhāraṇīya</i> and <i>Adhāraṇīya Vegas</i> .                                                                             |

| Lec. | Pre-reading Essay                                                                | Lecture Topic                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 25   | The Brain-Body Nexus in <i>Āyurveda</i>                                          | <i>Sthūla, Sūkṣma</i> and <i>Kāraṇa Śarīra</i> . <i>Triguṇa-Tridoṣa</i> interactions. <i>Sattvaguṇa</i> and mental well-being.                                                            |
| 26   | Which medical system can answer the patient's most difficult question: "Why me?" | Concept and classification of diseases. Mechanism of disease production and progression.                                                                                                  |
| 27   | <i>Āyurveda</i> - Preventive or curative?                                        | Disease classifications in <i>Āyurvedic</i> texts. <i>Vyādhikṣamatva</i> (host immunity).                                                                                                 |
| 28   | What does living in alignment with nature really mean?                           | <i>Trividham Auśadham: Daivavyapāśraya, Yuktivyapāśraya</i> and <i>Sattvāvajaya</i> . Therapeutic resources of <i>Āyurveda</i> .                                                          |
| 29   | Understanding therapeutics with biophysics alongside biochemistry                | <i>Ṣaḍupakrama</i> : Sixfold treatment and the biophysical framework of <i>Āyurvedic</i> therapeutics.                                                                                    |
| 30   | Sustainable health or unsustainable healthcare?                                  | <i>Āyurvedic</i> diagnosis: <i>Roga</i> and <i>Rogī Parīkṣā</i> . <i>Trividha, Aṣṭasthāna</i> and <i>Daśavidha Parīkṣā</i> with emphasis on <i>Netra, Jihvā</i> and <i>Nāḍī Parīkṣā</i> . |